

Marked Report: "Which Vehicle Should I Pick?"

Own editing marks visible on the original

18

/ 25

Your best-controlled piece yet — a genuinely clever structural device, let down by a handful of word-level slips

The car-breaks-down-so-it's-boat-or-plane dilemma is tightly told, and splitting the piece with a magazine-style subheading ("My biggest fear.") is a proper technique, not a gimmick — it's not something most students your age would think to try. What's holding this back from a 20+ is the same thing as last time: a few words that sound right but aren't quite the correct form, plus an ending that trails off on "..." again instead of landing properly.

Three of today's slips — "seat **handrest**," "the plane would **go**" (go *where?*), and the leftover "**pearl** plane" — are exactly the pattern flagged in your last report: something that sounds close enough while you're writing fast, but doesn't hold up on a slow re-read. The crossings-out on your own page show you're already catching plenty of these live — the next skill is doing one more full read-back once the piece is finished, out loud, before calling it done.

MARK BREAKDOWN

Content & Ideas

6 / 7

A clear, well-paced dilemma-to-resolution arc (car sabotaged → boat-or-plane choice → airport → turbulence → safe landing). Loses a mark only because it ends on "..." right after landing rather than a proper closing thought.

Structure & Organisation

5 / 6

The "My biggest fear." subheading and the colon-marked time-jump ("Half an hour later:") are genuinely advanced devices, used with confidence. Just needs a final beat after landing to round the structure off.

Style: Vocabulary & Variety

4 / 6

"Hands shook like I was holding glass," "legs were jelly," "fear crept up my spine" — a strong triplet of similes. But "seat handrest" and "the plane would go" aren't quite the right words, and cost clarity marks.

Technical Accuracy

3 / 6

Several small fixable slips (missing dialogue punctuation, "of a car" instead of "of my car," a stray leftover word). Genuinely good evidence of self-correction while writing — several errors were already caught and crossed out on the original page.

ANNOTATED EXTRACT

Which vehicle should I pick?

I had been thinking about none of this one hour ago. I was supposed to be driving to France by car (because there were no trains available); however, when I got to start my car I realised I had been robbed of some of the most important components of a car¹. So now I had two options: go on a boat or an aeroplane. I was terrified of both of them.

In the end, I chose to be on an aeroplane as I had a feeling I would vomit on a boat. "Hi could I get a taxi to the airport. Really, thanks!"² I called while waiting on the large, dusty, grey pavement.

Half an hour later: I was at the airport, post security and waiting for my flight. During the wait, my hands shook like I was holding glass, my legs were jelly and fear crept up my spine. Finally after the wait I was on the plane.

My biggest fear.

For every jolt on it³ after takeoff, I was worried that the plane would go plummeting straight towards the ground. I held on to the seat handrest⁴ until my knuckles were snow white. Whoosh! the plane would go⁵ every once in a while, making my heart skip a beat.

Eventually I arrived in one piece and was the first to leave the pearl plane⁶...

NUMBERED CORRECTIONS

#	TYPE	ISSUE	FIX
1	Reference	You've already told us it's <i>your</i> car — calling it "a car" the second time reads like a different, random car.	"robbed of some of the most important components of my car"
2	Punctuation	A spoken request needs a comma after the greeting and a question mark, not a full stop.	"Hi, could I get a taxi to the airport, please? Thanks so much!"
3	Clarity	"on it" is vague this far from "plane" — cutting it is cleaner than patching it.	"For every jolt after takeoff"
4	Wrong word	The part of a seat you grip isn't called a "handrest" — that word doesn't exist in English.	"I held on to the armrest"
5	Missing word / capital	"The plane would go" is missing what it actually does — and a new sentence after "Whoosh!" needs a capital letter.	"Whoosh! The plane would lurch every once in a while"
6	Leftover word	"Pearl" doesn't belong here — looks like a word that should have been crossed out fully wasn't.	"the first to leave the plane..."

A real structural idea, not just a story

- Splitting the piece with a bold subheading ("*My biggest fear.*") is a magazine/article device — it signals a shift in focus without needing a clumsy linking sentence.
- "Half an hour later:" uses a colon to jump time cleanly, echoing the confident one-word-sentence trick from your last piece.
- Three well-chosen descriptors again — "*large, dusty, grey pavement*" — you're clearly using this technique on purpose now, not by accident.

Editing as you go

- Multiple live corrections visible on your own page (fixing verb tense, swapping in "however," catching "unavailable" and rewording it) — this is exactly the habit that will eventually catch things like the "handrest" slip too.
- A tight triplet of similes for fear — "*hands shook like I was holding glass,*" "*legs were jelly,*" "*fear crept up my spine*" — shows real control of tone, not just description for its own sake.
- The turbulence section builds real physical tension (white knuckles, the jolt, the "Whoosh!") — a reader can feel it.

NEXT STEPS

This is the same honest note as last time, because it's still the main thing between you and a 20+: (1) read the finished piece back out loud once, slowly — "seat handrest" and "the plane would go" both sound almost right when you're writing at speed, which is exactly why a live read-back catches them and a quick glance doesn't; (2) check any word you've referred to earlier in the piece stays consistent the second time ("my car," not "a car"); and (3) budget the last two minutes for a proper ending sentence instead of trailing off on "..." — you'd already survived the flight here, so one closing line (how it felt to be back on solid ground) would have finished the piece rather than just stopping it.